

The Message Without a Voice

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Read again. Underline one misunderstanding and one action that helps the friendship.

- A** On Monday evening, Noam opened the school website on his family's computer. His class was preparing a book sale for a community library. He wanted to make friends with Eitan, the new boy, so he asked him to help with the display. Eitan's answer appeared a minute later: "Do it yourself."
- B** Noam read the three words again. They sounded like an order. "He thinks he is better than me," Noam told his brother. He felt his face grow hot. He started writing an angry answer, then stopped. Tomorrow, he decided, he would cancel their work together.
- C** The next morning, Noam put the books on the table alone. His main concern was the welcome sign. The letters were uneven, and the table looked empty. When Eitan approached him with a large blue bag, Noam turned away. "You don't need to help," he said. "I can see that you don't want to."
- D** Eitan put down the bag. "What about the rest of my message?" he asked. Noam showed him the screen. Eitan looked surprised. "The second part is missing! I wrote, 'Do it yourself for now. My little brother needs help. I can bring the stand tomorrow.'"
- E** From his bag, Eitan took out a wooden stand. There was blue paint on his fingers. He and his father finished it late the night before. Suddenly, Noam understood why Eitan answered so quickly.
- F** "I assumed you were angry," Noam said. "But I didn't know for sure."
- G** "My first words were unfriendly," Eitan replied. "I agree. I should explain things more clearly."
- H** For a moment, neither boy spoke. Then Noam moved the books, and Eitan placed the stand in the middle. The welcome sign fitted perfectly.
- I** Noam still remembered the hurt he felt. A missing sentence did not immediately make that feeling disappear. However, the stand was evidence that Eitan cared about their project. Noam thanked him and asked about his brother.
- J** That afternoon, they wrote a short rule for their next project: "If a message sounds strange, ask before you assume." In other words, three words do not always tell the whole story.
- K** As the first visitors arrived, Eitan stood behind the table. Noam moved his own chair beside him. "This one is yours," he said. Eitan sat down, and they opened the first box together.

Read • Find evidence • Explain

Write in full sentences. Add a paragraph letter when asked.

1. What was the class preparing? Give the paragraph letter.

2. What did Noam think Eitan meant? What did Eitan actually mean? Use paragraphs B and D.

3. Which two details show that Eitan wanted to help? Give the paragraph letter.

4. Put the events in the correct order. Write the letters.

A. Eitan explains the missing message.

B. Noam reads the short message.

C. The boys welcome the first visitors.

D. Eitan brings a wooden stand.

Order: 1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____ 4. _____

5. Why does Noam move his chair at the end? Explain what his action suggests. Use paragraph K.

6. Noam still feels hurt. Why does he thank Eitan anyway? Use paragraph I.

Choose • Write • Check

Circle one answer in each question. Then write your own paragraph.

- 1. I took your book _____. I thought it was mine.
A. on purpose B. by mistake C. at last
- 2. She worked hard to _____ her goal.
A. achieve B. describe C. forget
- 3. I checked the date twice. I am _____ the test is on Sunday.
A. afraid B. lonely C. certain
- 4. I _____ with you.
A. agree B. am agreeing C. agrees
- 5. Noam was still hurt. _____, he thanked Eitan for the stand.
A. Because B. However C. For example
- 6. Noam misunderstood Eitan _____ part of the message was missing.
A. however B. although C. because

Writing • 70–100 words

Write about a misunderstanding between two friends. Explain what happened, what each friend thought, and how they solved the problem. You may invent a story.

Use three: by mistake • however • understanding • so far • achieve • relations • certain • be responsible for something

Check: a clear problem and solution • mainly Past Simple • because and however